

The Division Commander's Guide to Success



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FOREWORD

His glasses delicately balanced on his forehead like a hummingbird hovering mid-breath. One hand on his hip and the other preparing to make clear what his words might not.

I will always remember my first Craig Vogel communication lesson.

There I sat, a newly-minted associate database developer on my new team. There he stood, our revered Vice President. The captain and the kid. He asked me for information on a project I was working on, to which I gave the equivalent of an “I don’t know” for an answer.

“Listen..it’s like this, right? Just wait. Are you ready?” and then he dressed me down through a series of turns of phrase and unique strings of words I would soon learn were but a fraction of his rhetorical tool-belt we have affectionately titled ‘Craig-isms’.

They can be clever, crass, hilarious, confusing, and brilliant. Just like the man.

We enjoyed assembling this collection almost as much as we enjoyed receiving the messages. Each one a gift; Presented here together as a gift for their author.

We thank him for the laughs, wisdom, and occasional threats to our employment.

“Your communications degree is showing..”

- Tom Yoder
November 2025

Step 1:

You're Fired



“I hate you, Zach.”

April 9, 2025

“I can’t set a lower bar.”

September 29, 2025

“I don’t like how you’re talking
to me.”

As an animated dinosaur

“Demote your ass before you
die.”

October 19, 2023

“I’m going to need you to get
your thinking back into the
box.”

August 12, 2024

“I am just going to fire you. It
will be easier this way.”

September 24, 2024

“What is wrong with people.”

December 27, 2024

“You’ve never been more wrong
than you are at this moment.”

April 30, 2025

“It doesn’t have anything to do
with you... or your attitude... or
how horrible you are most of
the time. Or having a bike that is
collecting dust.”

November 5, 2025

“I am sorry that you are
difficult.”

November 5, 2025

“You’re fired. Go pack your
stuff.”

to Nick Strubbe

“Your idea is horrible.”

Craig Vogel

“Yes.”

Gail Benefiel

“Go f yourself.”

“Why are you never at your
desk? Come see me after.
Nothing important. Fire you
later.”

“One day you will understand. I’m
amazed you made it this far.”

“And you will take whatever
team member I decide to land
on your team.”

July 28, 2025

“You’ll be lucky to make it through
today.”

February 14, 2025

To Nick Strubbe

Step 2:

Stop Doing Dumb
Sh!t



“Geezus.”

February 26, 2024

“Don’t do dumb things and
dumb things don’t happen.”

July 14, 2025

“They are going to lose me if they
show me a PPT slide.”

November 15, 2024

“Sorry, trying to focus on the
stupid sh!t that I need not never
doing now.”

June 24, 2025

“Tell them every bad deploy a
team member is going to lose a
finger.”

April 10, 2024

“That sh!t is going to be the
death of me.”

“Look here, F-ers... Stop doing
X.”

December 4, 2024

“Ummm... why is he speaking.”

July 22, 2025

“Wait.. are you volunteering for
it to be your fault? Yes, it’s your
fault.”

September 2, 2025

“For stupid sh!t. Like
Applebees.”

August 6, 2025

“It's like the Cliffs of Insanity...
they just go on and on.”

April 22, 2025

“Geezus Christmas... tell him to
pound sand.”

January 23, 2025

“To quote Anakin Skywalker....
“uuuuuugggg gggghhhhhhhh.”

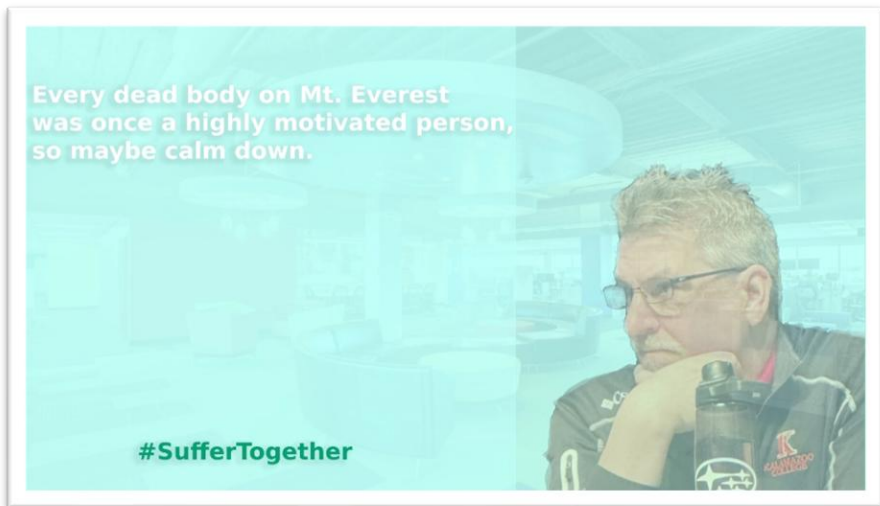
September 16, 2025

“Locaine Powder comes to
mind.”

April 21, 2025

Step 3:

Why Do You Hate America?



“Why do you hate America?”

“Why do I hate America?”

February 4, 2025

“I need someone to go downstairs
and get me some additional Kool
Aid.”

October 2, 2025

“Stop hitting the 420.”

March 19, 2024

“Warehouse does something... then
Talend does something... and then
we eat the minstrels?”

November 25, 2025

“Is he saying Frog Protection?”

September 20, 2023

“I just work here, Zach. I can’t fix
stupid.”

“The paint is dry.”

“When you are not being 'Barb
like'... you're okay.”

December 4, 2025

“I had to Google Sundowning, so
thanks for that information.”

November 11, 2025

“It’s another beautiful morning!



July 16, 2025

“I’m so tired.”

“Sometimes you tell the day by
the bottle you drink.”

September 19, 2025

“I’m tired of being oppressed by
all you gluten-loving carb
addicts.”

“I can’t work under these
conditions, Michael.”

November 5, 2025

“Division Commander III here I
come.”

October, 14, 2025

“Can you click your Yourtime.”

January 15, 2025

“Throat punch him.”

January 23, 2025

“Thanks, I feel better now. I am going to make sure to pull plastic out of the dolphin’s blow hole so that they survive.”

“Need you to kick him in the
ballz.”

February 17, 2025

“If Fisher doesn’t kill someone...
that will be good.”

February 10, 2025

“Zach, the first step to solving a problem is admitting you have one... and you have a problem
”

“I am going to give you a sheriff's
badge to shoot people.”

“A rainbow of cash flowing out of
a pig’s buttocks.”

Step 4:

You Have Beautiful
Eyes



“Scott, not only do you have
beautiful eyes but I also
appreciate you helping to
promote our amazing
organization.”

October 14, 2025

“Look, Tom doesn’t just have
the most beautiful eyes... he
also has substance.”

“Kaushik, I’m not sure why you
went to Hawaii and spent a
billion dollars you could have
spent a ton less and gone to
Ohio.”

sharing picture of world’s largest horseshoe crab

“It’s the Jedi Mind Trick...
approving it before you ask for
it.”

July 2, 2025

“You know. This is why you ride bikes... you don’t get appendix problems. Never heard Lance Armstrong go ‘can’t ride the Tour de France today... Appendix...”

September 2, 2025

“It’s the mountain on the mountain
that I struggle with. The peyote tent
that gives me power, etc.”

September 26, 2025

“Where are you hiding Tom?”

first message to Tom Yoder

“I totally get it. There are nights
where I am like.. I just want a
drink.. and then six drinks later.....”

September 22, 2023

“Rob, with great power... comes
great responsibility.”

October 8, 2024

“Scott this is like choose your own
adventure.. just make up the
acronym because no one can refute
it because they don't know either.”

September 24, 2025

“Thanks for the heads up. I won't
text you to find out if you're in a
ditch.”

November 24, 2025

“Nice job surviving.”

“This is what leaders do. We look out for our team. Not always in appropriate ways, but you should take what you can get.”

October 14, 2025

“I am glad that you and your house
didn't burn down.”

October 15, 2025

“Yes. I would be your friend
today.”

“You’re the ocean not the person
standing in the ocean!”

“I totally didn’t think that was what
Tom looked like.”

December 12, 2024

Bonus Chapter

The Musings of Craig



“Brian... this world has existed for
a long time... I feel like I could
have my own ‘zoi’ era... The
Craigzoic period. Or should it be
Craigazoic.”

December 5, 2025

“If you were a tree what kind of
tree would you be?”

September 25, 2024

“I need to plan a trip to go see the
world’s biggest ball of twine.”

July 22, 2024

“Craig-bot. It knows where all the
bodies are buried.”

“This is off the hook.”

February 10, 2025



“Bring your air inflator when you come in today. I have giant ducks to inflate.”

“The full Latin name is
Craigosaurus Rex.”

“I'm so excited. My twine came
today.”

“Team name is 'Lake
Life'? Apparently Lake and Bake
isn't going to pass the sniff test.”

October 7, 2025

“I know... I am like Morris the
Cat.”

October 9, 2024

“I love hotdogs.”

“Cause that's
what I do. I
take care of my
family.”

September 24, 2025

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